

MUHAMMED AJAS

Senior Site Reliability Engineer | Platform Engineering | Kubernetes | Cloud Automation

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Notice Period: 30 Days

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Site Reliability Engineer with 10+ years of experience designing, automating, and operating enterprise-scale SaaS platforms across IBM Cloud, AWS, and hybrid cloud environments. Manages production infrastructure spanning 300+ Kubernetes clusters supporting 500+ enterprise customers. Builds internal automation platforms that cut manual operations, strengthen reliability, and lower cloud spend; leads a team of 11 engineers and serves as Incident Commander for critical Sev-1 production issues. AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: IBM Cloud, AWS, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform (GCP)

AWS Services: EKS, EC2, Lambda, IAM, CloudFormation, ELB, SNS, SQS, Secrets Manager

Containers & Platform Engineering: Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, Podman

IaC & CI/CD: Terraform (reusable modules, remote state), Ansible, Jenkins, GitHub, GitHub Actions

Programming & Automation: Python, Flask, Bash, REST APIs, YAML, JSON

Observability: Instana, Sysdig, IBM Cloud Logs (LogDNA/Mezmo), AWS CloudWatch, Splunk

Security: HashiCorp Vault, IBM/AWS Secrets Manager, IAM, GuardDuty, SSL/TLS Certificate Management, Kubernetes Secrets

Databases & Networking: MongoDB, DB2, MySQL; VPC Peering, AWS Transit Gateway, Direct Connect

IT Operations: Incident Management, PagerDuty, ServiceNow, Jira, Root Cause Analysis (RCA), Agile, ITIL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Site Reliability Engineer – Cognos Analytics on Cloud – IBM India Pvt. Ltd.

October 2022 – Present — Kochi, India

- Designed and developed RootCause Helper, an automated forensic diagnostics platform that preserves application, Kubernetes, database, infrastructure, and network logs before pod or node recovery — supporting roughly 15 production incidents per month and materially cutting Mean Time to Recovery (MTTR).
- Architected a Customer Self-Service Platform (Python, Flask, MongoDB, Kubernetes APIs, REST services) that replaced manual email-driven onboarding by automating SSL uploads, custom URLs, SMTP configuration, contact management, and controlled cluster restarts.
- Automated enterprise security and certificate compliance using HashiCorp Vault APIs (password rotation, audit automation, legacy-credential detection) and full SSL/Kubernetes Secret lifecycle management, preventing certificate-expiration incidents.
- Reduced monthly IBM Cloud infrastructure costs by approximately \$19,000/month through Kubernetes resource right-sizing, CPU/memory optimization, automated orphaned-storage cleanup, and improved cluster decommission workflows.
- Strengthened observability across 300+ Kubernetes clusters supporting 500+ enterprise customers with proactive monitoring, distributed tracing, and improved alerting; integrated Instana, Sysdig, IBM Cloud Logs, CloudWatch, and Splunk.
- Developed reusable Terraform modules with remote state management to standardize infrastructure provisioning.

- Served as Incident Commander for 10+ enterprise Sev-1 incidents and led disaster recovery during a regional data center outage, coordinating cross-functional teams while maintaining customer SLAs.
- Led and mentored a team of 11 Site Reliability Engineers — technical interviews, pull request and architecture reviews, and technical sessions on SRE and cloud automation.
- Led monthly production maintenance windows covering Kubernetes node and cluster upgrades, ingress controller updates, application version updates, and security fix/patch rollouts across the environment.

Cloud Architect / Site Reliability Engineer – Pfizer – Tata Consultancy Services

September 2019 – October 2022 — Montevideo, Uruguay

- Led cloud infrastructure discussions with Pfizer engineering teams and migrated enterprise workloads from on-premises to AWS and hybrid cloud with zero production downtime, within a global nearshore delivery model.
- Designed secure AWS networking architectures using VPC Peering, Transit Gateway, Direct Connect, and Elastic Load Balancers.
- Implemented AWS IAM governance, GuardDuty monitoring, encryption, and Secrets Manager integration, extending cloud security controls across AWS, Azure, and GCP.
- Built automation using AWS Lambda and Python to streamline operational workflows and improve infrastructure consistency.

Cloud Engineer – Pfizer – Tata Consultancy Services

September 2017 – September 2019 — Kochi, India

- Managed enterprise hybrid cloud operations, including OS patching, backup, and infrastructure maintenance.
- Configured CloudWatch monitoring and proactive alerting; supported AWS EC2, IAM, CloudFormation, SNS, SQS, and enterprise networking components.
- Managed enterprise backup and recovery operations using EMC Networker.

System Engineer / Technical Service Desk Engineer – Gartner – Tata Consultancy Services

August 2016 – September 2017 — Bengaluru, India

- Served as primary technical contact for global enterprise customers, resolving complex incidents while consistently meeting SLA commitments.
- Applied ITIL best practices for incident management and service requests, collaborating with global infrastructure and application teams.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate

ITIL Foundation Certified

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Computer Applications (BCA) — Mahatma Gandhi University, Kerala, India

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

Core Group Member, Progressive Techies Kerala. Delivered technical sessions on Kubernetes, SRE, Cloud Automation, and DevOps best practices for engineering teams and technical communities.